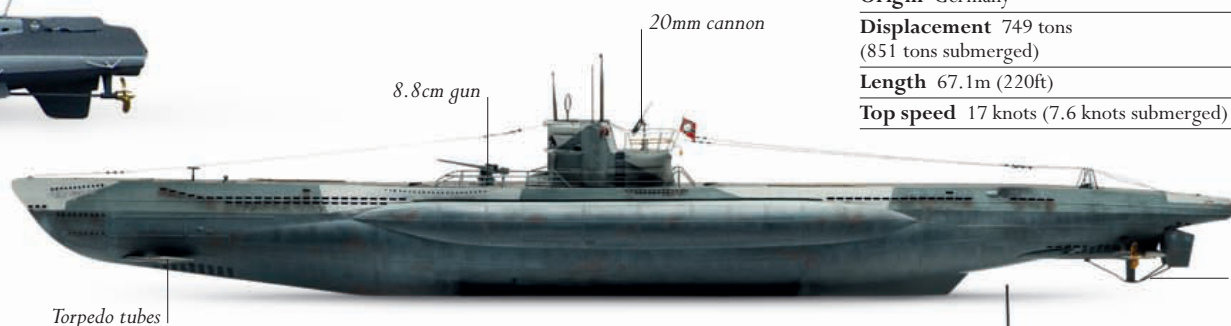




## ▼ GERMAN TYPE VIIC

Commissioned 1940–44

Origin Germany

Displacement 749 tons  
(851 tons submerged)

Length 67.1m (220ft)

Top speed 17 knots (7.6 knots submerged)

The Type VII boats were built in very large numbers from 1936 to 1943. The VIICs predominated, and no less than 663 were completed. They were the workhorses of the German submarine service. Operating chiefly in the Atlantic from ports in western France, they came close to cutting the vital supply chain from North America on which Britain depended.

## ▼ USS GATO

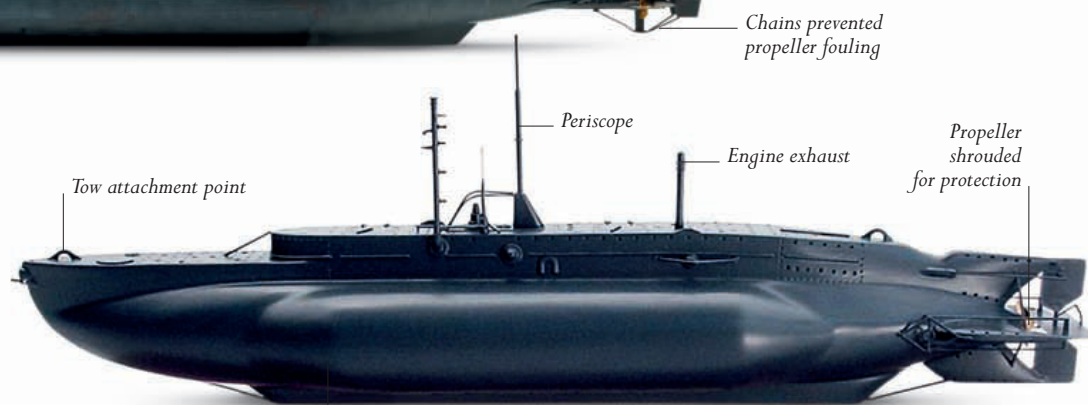
Commissioned 1941 Origin US

Displacement 1,810 tons  
(2,410 tons submerged)

Length 95m (311½ft)

Top speed 20 knots (8.75 knots submerged)

USS *Gato* was the leader of one of three near-identical classes of “fleet boats” that equipped the US Navy during World War II. Each class was modified extensively during and after the war. *Gato* itself survived as a training boat until the 1960s, but some in the class were transferred to other navies in the 1970s and remained in service until the 1990s.



## ▲ RN X-CRAFT

Commissioned 1942–45 Origin UK

Displacement 26.9 tons  
(29.7 tons submerged)

Length 15.7m (51½ft)

Top speed 6 knots (5 knots submerged)

Just 23 of these midget submarines were built for the British Royal Navy. With a crew of four, including a diver, their weapons were two 2-ton “side-charges” – mines carried along the sides of the hull – which were released to lie on the seabed below their intended targets.



## ► I-400

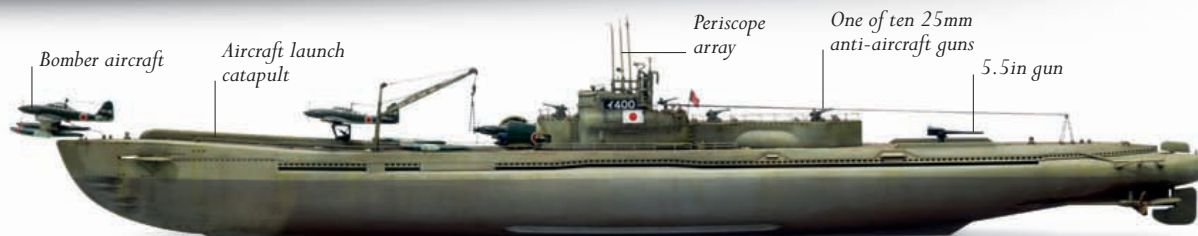
Commissioned 1944 Origin Japan

Displacement 5,225 tons  
(6,560 tons submerged)

Length 122m (401¼ft)

Top speed 18.7 knots (6.5 knots submerged)

The *Sen Toku* class consisted of submarine aircraft carriers built to launch airstrikes on the locks in the Panama Canal linking the Atlantic and the Pacific oceans. Eighteen were ordered, but just three were completed, one of which was converted into a tanker during construction. They were the largest submarines constructed until the US Navy's nuclear-powered *George Washington* class appeared in the 1960s.



## ▼ WILHELM BAUER

Commissioned 1945 Origin Germany

Displacement 1,595 tons  
(1,790 tons submerged)

Length 76.7m (251½ft)

Top speed 15.6 knots  
(17.2 knots submerged)

The last of the Kriegsmarine's ocean-going submarines, the Type XXIs were the most effective by a considerable margin. A total of 121 were commissioned. *Wilhelm Bauer*, originally *U-2540*, was scuttled on 4 May 1945, but was raised 12 years later and put back into commission by the *Bundesmarine*. It is now a museum ship at Bremerhaven.

